

Bar-Model Word Problems Mission

Warm-up and worked example

Name: _____

Date: _____

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YOUR MISSION Use bar models to expose the structure of challenging multi-step problems.

SMART MOVE Draw a simpler case and organize what you know.

Math Talk

What can a drawing reveal that an equation alone might hide?

My idea:

New Words

represent	deduce	assumption
My meaning or picture:	My meaning or picture:	My meaning or picture:

Worked Example

Do this example with your teacher. Say what changes and what stays the same.

- 1. Read a problem without calculating.
- 2. Identify the whole, parts, comparisons, and unknown.

What the example shows: _____

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Learn it and show your thinking

Name: _____

Date: _____

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YOUR MISSION Follow the learning path, then explain the big idea.

SMART MOVE Draw before asking for a rule.

[] **Step 1:** Read a problem without calculating.

[] **Step 2:** Identify the whole, parts, comparisons, and unknown.

[] **Step 3:** Draw a labeled bar model.

[] **Step 4:** Write equations from the model.

[] **Step 5:** Solve and verify in context.

My model, drawing, or organized work:

The big idea in my own words:

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Practice lab

Name: _____

Date: _____

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YOUR MISSION Use a model, equation, or explanation for every task.

SMART MOVE Check whether your answer is reasonable.

1. One part-whole problem.

2. One comparison problem.

3. One multiply-then-add problem.

4. One problem with an unknown starting amount.

Choose one answer and prove it another way:

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Challenge and final check

Name: _____

Date: _____

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YOUR MISSION Try an unfamiliar problem and defend your reasoning.

SMART MOVE A wrong first idea can still lead to a strong solution.

Challenge Mission

Three teams score 148 points altogether. Team A scores 17 more than Team B. Team C scores 52. Find one possible score pair for A and B. Is the answer unique?

My plan:

My solution and proof:

Final Check

Draw a bar model for the hardest problem and explain each label.

☐ I can teach it

☐ I need practice

☐ I need help

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Reusable math tool

Name: _____

Date: _____

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YOUR MISSION Use this page to draw, model, organize, and check.

SMART MOVE Draw a simpler case and organize what you know.

Problem-Solving Organizer

What I know

What I need to find

My model or table

My equations

My check and explanation
